European Commission

Flash Eurobarometer 564

Future needs in digital education



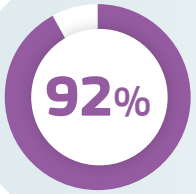
Digital skills are universally recognised as fundamental

Vast majorities of EU citizens agree that...

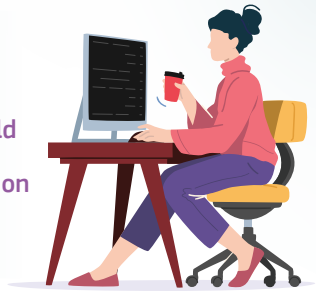
89% Digital skills are essential for participation in society (for example for banking, healthcare, community engagement, etc.)

80% Digital skills are essential to have a successful career

86% Expanding digital skills training is important to improve the economy

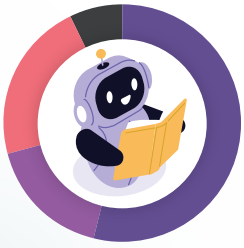


Widespread agreement that **digital skills should be taught to everyone at all levels of education**



More and specific guidance is needed on AI in education

Appropriate use of AI in education is a topic of great interest, but also concern for EU citizens



54% AI can benefit and bring risks to teaching and learning. The education community should assess and explore both

17% AI can improve teaching and learning. The education community should not be afraid to experiment with it

22% AI does not belong in the classroom

7% Don't know

Most EU citizens agree that...

85%

Digital skills are necessary to be able to use generative AI tools safely and responsibly

81%

All teachers should be equipped with the skills to use and understand AI, including generative AI

Promoting digital technologies specifically designed for learning



87%

A broad consensus in favour of **promoting digital technologies specifically designed for learning in schools**



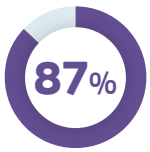
69%



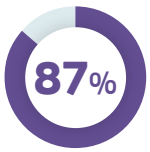
of EU citizens **support a ban of smartphones in schools**

Benefits of digital technologies for education

Most respondents see benefits of digital technologies for education



access to tailored learning



more innovative education and training



more accessible and inclusive education and training

Fostering learners' digital wellbeing and mental health

Most EU citizens agree that...



88%

Teachers should play a key role in supporting children in developing the skills needed for interacting safely with technology



87%

Parents and families have a crucial role in teaching their children how to use technology safely and responsibly



92%

Schools should teach young people how to manage the impact of digital technologies, such as social media, on their mental and physical health

Education systems should equip learners with skills to recognise disinformation

80%



of EU citizens agree that digital literacy help protect them from being misled by online disinformation

89%

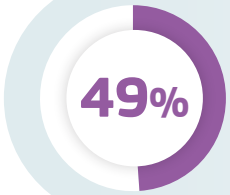


Widespread support that **all teachers should be equipped with the skills to help students in recognising various forms of disinformation online** (i.e. fake online content, AI-generated false text/videos/images)

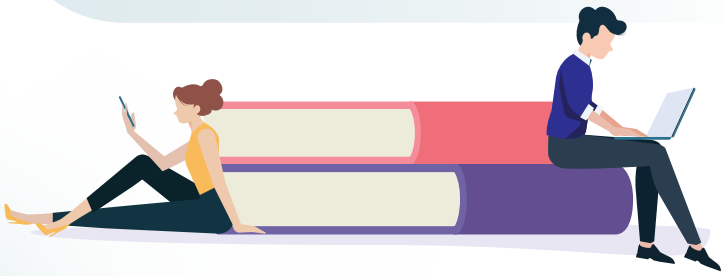


An important role for the EU for setting up standards

The EU can best support successful digital education across EU Member States by...



49% Developing EU standards for the use of digital technology in education, for example on data privacy or in using artificial intelligence in education

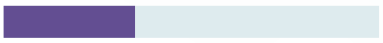


36%



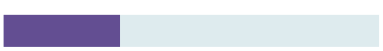
Providing funding for equipment and infrastructure, including internet connections

35%



Offering opportunities to help people improve their digital skills

31%



Develop an EU approach to teaching and assessing digital skills

23%



Help companies develop European technologies for education

Source: **Flash Eurobarometer 564 – Future needs in digital education**
(fieldwork: from 7 to 14 May 2025, 25 781 online interviews with EU citizens, aged 15 and over, in the 27 EU Member States)
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